



Figure 2: The main window

minute interval too, for the paranoid ones, I guess.

Next is the *Include* tab. If you want a back-up of your entire system—excluding mounted drives, CDs and USB or network drives—you'd add only one entry here: */* (i.e., slash).

Move on to the next tab and configure the 'excludes' here. There are a few predefined patterns here, to make sure temporary files and back-ups aren't backed up. Add a few folders to it: */media*, */mnt*, */proc* and */tmp*.

The next tab is *Auto-remove* that lets you set which snapshots to remove automatically. I think it's safe to leave all *options* enabled here. This optimises disk space usage.

The Options tab has only one option to enable notifications and it should be enabled (duh!). In the next tab (*Expert Options*), it's a safe bet to keep the second option (i.e., run 'nice' as a *cron* job) enabled.

The main window

The main window is a rather clean design. It helps you get your job done fast and do away with it (Figure 2).

On the top is a toolbar (no menu bar) with just

the number of buttons required: *Backup Now* (to take a manual snapshot), *Update Snapshots* (to rescan for snapshots), *Snapshot Name* (to specify a name for a certain snapshot, which makes it really special), *Remove Snapshot*, *Settings*, *About*, *Help* and *Exit*. Note that the UI is the same for both KDE4 and GTK+; they only look different.

Taking a back up is as simple as clicking *Backup Now*. All it takes is a few minutes, while *diff* is run to check for changes; changed files are copied over and unchanged files are linked. Restoring is even more of a no-brainer—on the *Snapshots* pane, click on a snapshot that you want to restore. If you want to restore the whole back-up, click on *Restore*. If you want to extract just a few files, select your snapshot, then browse to the desired files on the rightmost pane and just drag them out to your desktop or some folder. It's that simple!

Backing up to network servers

This really isn't rocket science. Remember FreeNAS? You can just set up a NFS server like that (or set up an NFS on your back-up server, if you have one) and mount it on your PC to back up the data to the NFS share.

My thoughts

If I had a large external hard drive dedicated to taking back-ups—500GB drives don't cost much—I would have installed this on all of my distros. As it is, I'm not averse to back-ups; I just wish I had disk space for them.

Oh, and forget the floppies, tape drives and back-ups on DVDs. No one takes them any more. 

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